

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAIKULAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – PR7 INTERVIEW

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

Section A: Extract-Based Comprehension (3 × 5 = 15 marks)

Extract 1:

“The interviewer holds a position of unprecedented power and influence. He can elicit information, shape opinions, and even alter the course of events. Yet, the interview remains a controversial genre, often accused of being intrusive and diminishing its subject.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does the author suggest about the power of the interviewer?

- (a) They are passive observers
- (b) They can influence outcomes
- (c) They only record facts
- (d) They lack credibility **Answer:** (b) They can influence outcomes

Q2: Why is the interview considered controversial?

- (a) It is often scripted
- (b) It is used only for entertainment
- (c) It invades privacy and reduces the subject
- (d) It is not widely practiced **Answer:** (c) It invades privacy and reduces the subject

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Interviews are a powerful journalistic tool. Reason: They allow the interviewer to manipulate the subject's responses.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.

Q4: Assertion: Interviews are universally admired. Reason: They always portray the subject positively.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: The interview is often accused of being _____ and reducing its subject to a mere object.

Answer: intrusive

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes the tone used by the author in this extract?

- (a) Reverent
- (b) Critical
- (c) Humorous
- (d) Indifferent **Answer:** (b) Critical

Extract 2:

“Umberto Eco has a huge readership, but he says he is a university professor who writes novels on Sundays. He explains that his success lies in his ability to ‘interstices’—to use the empty spaces in his schedule productively.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does Umberto Eco mean by ‘interstices’?

- (a) Leisure time
- (b) Gaps between major tasks
- (c) Holidays
- (d) Time spent teaching **Answer:** (b) Gaps between major tasks

Q2: What is Eco’s primary profession?

- (a) Novelist
- (b) Journalist
- (c) University professor
- (d) Historian **Answer:** (c) University professor

Q3: How does Eco describe his writing schedule?

- (a) He writes daily
- (b) He writes only during vacations
- (c) He writes novels on Sundays
- (d) He writes during lectures **Answer:** (c) He writes novels on Sundays

Q4: What does Eco’s approach to time management reflect?

- (a) Laziness
- (b) Discipline and creativity
- (c) Disinterest in writing
- (d) Dependence on deadlines **Answer:** (b) Discipline and creativity

Q5: What contributes to Eco’s success according to the extract?

- (a) His fame
- (b) His teaching skills
- (c) His use of interstices
- (d) His interviews **Answer:** (c) His use of interstices

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q6: Assertion: Eco believes in using small gaps in time to write. Reason: He has no fixed schedule for writing.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

Q7: Assertion: Eco's novels are written during his teaching hours. Reason: He is a multitasker.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q8: Eco uses the _____ in his schedule to write creatively. **Answer:** interstices

Q9: Eco's primary identity is that of a _____ professor. **Answer:** university

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q10: Which word best describes Eco's attitude towards writing?

- (a) Casual
- (b) Strategic
- (c) Indifferent
- (d) Frustrated **Answer:** (b) Strategic

Extract 3:

"Some celebrities feel that they lose a part of themselves in interviews. They believe that their privacy is invaded and their words are twisted. Writers like Lewis Carroll and Rudyard Kipling were known to detest interviews, considering them immoral and offensive."

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What is the main concern of celebrities regarding interviews?

- (a) They are too long
- (b) They are not published widely
- (c) They invade privacy and distort meaning
- (d) They are conducted by amateurs **Answer:** (c) They invade privacy and distort meaning

Q2: How did Rudyard Kipling view interviews?

- (a) As a form of entertainment
- (b) As a moral obligation
- (c) As immoral and offensive
- (d) As a learning experience **Answer:** (c) As immoral and offensive

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: Some writers disliked interviews. Reason: They felt interviews misrepresented their thoughts.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

Q4: Assertion: Lewis Carroll enjoyed giving interviews. Reason: He liked sharing his personal life with readers.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: Rudyard Kipling considered interviews to be _____ and offensive. **Answer:** immoral

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes the tone used by the author in this extract?

- (a) Sympathetic
- (b) Neutral
- (c) Critical
- (d) Humorous **Answer:** (b) Neutral

□ Extract 4:

“Eco’s works are marked by a non-violent tone. He believes that children’s books should promote peace and understanding. His writing style is simple yet philosophical, allowing readers of all ages to engage with deep ideas without feeling overwhelmed.”

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What tone does Eco prefer in his writings?

- (a) Aggressive
- (b) Non-violent
- (c) Satirical
- (d) Sarcastic **Answer:** (b) Non-violent

Q2: What is unique about Eco’s writing style?

- (a) It is filled with complex jargon
- (b) It is humorous and casual
- (c) It is simple yet philosophical
- (d) It avoids deep ideas **Answer:** (c) It is simple yet philosophical

Q3: Why does Eco believe children’s books are important?

- (a) They entertain children
- (b) They promote peace and understanding
- (c) They help children memorize facts
- (d) They are easy to write **Answer:** (b) They promote peace and understanding

Q4: What does Eco's style allow readers to do?

- (a) Avoid thinking deeply
- (b) Engage with ideas without pressure
- (c) Focus only on entertainment
- (d) Skip philosophical content **Answer:** (b) Engage with ideas without pressure

Q5: What age group can relate to Eco's writing?

- (a) Only adults
- (b) Only children
- (c) All age groups
- (d) Only scholars **Answer:** (c) All age groups

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q6: Assertion: Eco's writing is accessible to all readers. Reason: He uses simple language to express deep ideas.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

Q7: Assertion: Eco's books promote violence and rebellion. Reason: He believes children should be exposed to harsh realities.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
- (c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.
- (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q8: Eco's writing style is _____ yet philosophical. **Answer:** simple

Q9: Eco believes children's books should promote _____ and understanding. **Answer:** peace

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q10: Which word best describes Eco's attitude towards writing for children?

- (a) Dismissive
- (b) Respectful
- (c) Indifferent
- (d) Frustrated **Answer:** (b) Respectful

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 × 2 = 24 marks)

Story-Based Questions (3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks)

Q1. Why is the interview described as a “supreme serviceable medium of communication”? **Answer:** The interview allows direct access to a person’s thoughts, experiences, and personality. It bridges the gap between public figures and the audience, making it a powerful tool for sharing ideas. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the medium’s role
- 1 mark for explaining its communicative value

Q2. What was Denis Brian’s opinion about interviews? **Answer:** Denis Brian believed interviews provide the best insight into people’s lives, offering authentic glimpses into their thoughts and emotions. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for stating the opinion
- 1 mark for explaining its significance

Q3. Why did some celebrities view interviews negatively? **Answer:** Celebrities like Lewis Carroll and Rudyard Kipling felt interviews invaded their privacy and diminished their persona, making them feel like their words were misrepresented. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the negative view
- 1 mark for giving examples

Value-Based Questions (3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks)

Q4. What values are reflected in Umberto Eco’s approach to time management? **Answer:** Eco’s use of interstices shows discipline, productivity, and respect for intellectual work. He values time and uses small gaps effectively to write. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying values
- 1 mark for linking them to Eco’s habits

Q5. How does Eco’s humility emerge in the interview? **Answer:** Eco downplays his fame, calling himself a university professor who writes on Sundays. His modesty reflects humility despite his literary success. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying humility
- 1 mark for supporting it with textual evidence

Q6. What lesson can be drawn from Eco’s success with children’s books? **Answer:** Eco’s success shows that intellectual depth can be made accessible. His ability to simplify complex ideas teaches the value of clarity and audience awareness. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for stating the lesson
- 1 mark for explaining its relevance

Competency-Based Questions (4 × 2 Marks = 8 Marks)

Q7. How does the author use contrast to present different views on interviews? **Answer:** The author contrasts critics like Kipling with supporters like Denis Brian to show the interview’s dual nature—both intrusive and insightful. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying contrast
- 1 mark for explaining its effect

Q8. What does Eco's interview reveal about the relationship between philosophy and literature? Answer: Eco blends philosophical ideas into his narratives, showing that literature can carry deep meaning without being inaccessible. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the relationship
- 1 mark for citing Eco's approach

Q9. How does the interview format help reveal Eco's personality? Answer: Through candid responses, Eco's wit, humility, and intellectual clarity emerge. The format allows spontaneous insights into his character. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying personality traits
- 1 mark for linking them to the format

Q10. What does the chapter suggest about the role of interviews in modern journalism? Answer: Interviews are central to journalism, offering direct narratives and shaping public opinion. They are both informative and influential. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the role
- 1 mark for explaining its impact

Literary Device-Based Questions (2 × 2 Marks = 4 Marks)

Q11. Identify and explain the use of irony in the chapter. Answer: Irony lies in how some famous writers, known for their expressive works, disliked interviews—an expressive medium. This contradiction highlights the complexity of public personas. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying irony
- 1 mark for explaining its effect

Q12. What is the significance of the metaphor "interstices" in Eco's interview? Answer: "Interstices" metaphorically represents small time gaps that Eco uses productively. It signifies his ability to find meaning and creativity in overlooked moments. **Marking Scheme:**

- 1 mark for identifying the metaphor
- 1 mark for interpreting its significance

Section C: Long Answer Questions

1. Theme-Based Question

Q: Discuss the theme of public versus private identity in The Interview.

Answer: The Interview by Christopher Silvester explores the tension between a public figure's persona and their private self. Interviews, as a journalistic tool, offer a glimpse into the minds of celebrities, writers, and thinkers. However, they also raise questions about intrusion and authenticity.

Silvester presents contrasting views—while some like Denis Brian see interviews as insightful, others like Rudyard Kipling and Lewis Carroll find them offensive and diminishing. The interview format can reveal personal truths, but it can also distort or oversimplify complex personalities. Umberto Eco's interview shows how a subject can use the medium to clarify misconceptions and share genuine insights. The chapter highlights how public figures often struggle to maintain their privacy while being expected to remain accessible.

In conclusion, the theme of public versus private identity is central to the narrative. It encourages readers to reflect on the ethical boundaries of media and the responsibility of

interviewers to respect the dignity of their subjects. Interviews can be enlightening, but they must balance curiosity with compassion.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of theme
- 2 marks: Textual examples and analysis
- 1 mark: Interpretation and insight
- 1 mark: Coherent conclusion

2. Value-Based Question

Q: What values are reflected in Umberto Eco's literary philosophy?

Answer: Umberto Eco's literary philosophy, as revealed in his interview, reflects values of humility, discipline, and intellectual accessibility. Despite being a celebrated author, Eco identifies himself primarily as a university professor, showing his grounded nature and respect for academia.

Eco's use of "interstices"—small gaps in time—to write demonstrates his disciplined approach to creativity. He believes in embedding philosophical ideas into his narratives without making them obscure. His success with children's books shows his commitment to clarity and his respect for young readers. Eco's belief in non-violence and peace as recurring themes in his work further reflects his ethical and humanistic values.

In summary, Eco's philosophy is rooted in modesty, productivity, and a deep respect for his audience. He uses literature not to impress but to communicate meaningfully. His values make him not just a writer but a thoughtful educator, reminding us that true intellect lies in simplicity and sincerity.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Identification of values
- 2 marks: Supporting examples from the text
- 1 mark: Relevance to broader context
- 1 mark: Conclusion with reflection

3. Article-Based Question

Q: Write an article on "The Power of Interviews in Shaping Public Opinion" using *The Interview* as reference.

Answer: Interviews are a powerful medium in modern journalism, capable of shaping public opinion and revealing the human side of public figures. In *The Interview*, Christopher Silvester examines how interviews can be both informative and controversial.

The chapter presents varied perspectives—some view interviews as intrusive, while others see them as enlightening. Celebrities like Kipling feared misrepresentation, whereas Denis Brian believed interviews offered the best insight into people's lives. Umberto Eco's interview showcases how thoughtful responses can humanize intellectuals and make complex ideas relatable. The interviewer's role is crucial, as their questions and framing can guide public perception and even alter reputations.

In essence, interviews are more than conversations—they are curated narratives that shape how individuals are understood by society. When conducted ethically, they foster transparency and connection. *The Interview* reminds us that while interviews hold power, they

must balance curiosity with respect, ensuring that public opinion is shaped by truth rather than distortion.

Marking Scheme (5 marks):

- 1 mark: Introduction of concept
- 2 marks: Examples from the chapter
- 1 mark: Analysis of impact
- 1 mark: Conclusion with relevance